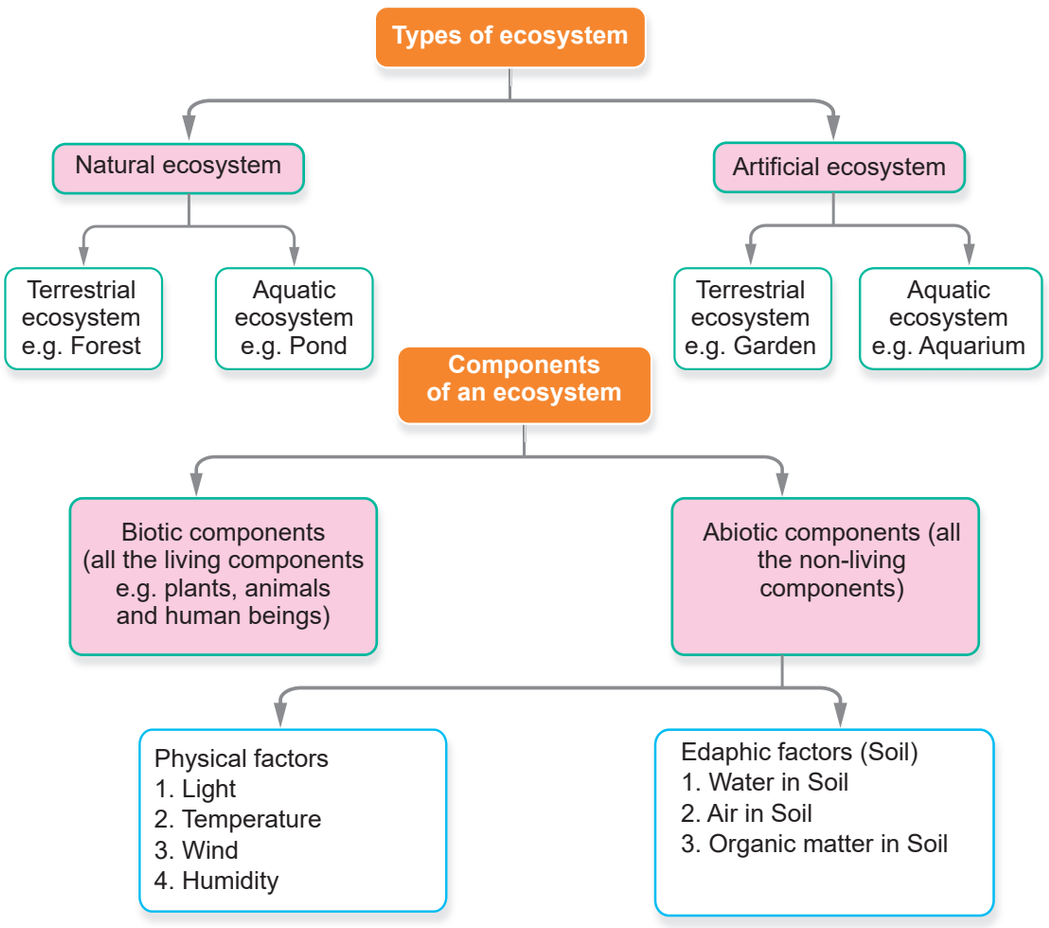
Introduction

The surroundings or space in which a person, animal, or plant lives, is known as an **environment**. Environment is everything that surrounds us. It can have both living (biotic) and non-living things (abiotic). **Abiotic factors** are non-living things such as sunlight, air, water and minerals in soil. **Biotic factors** are living things of our environment such as plants, animals, bacteria and more. Organisms live, constantly interact with one another and adapt themselves to conditions of their environment.

4.1 The Ecosystem

Ecosystem is a community of living and non-living things that work together. Each part of an ecosystem has a role to play. Any changes in the environment such as increased temperature or heavy rains, can have a big impact on an ecosystem.

Ecosystems can be either natural or artificial.



Activity 1: Think of the objects in your home. Just keep in mind, the books, toys, furniture, food materials and even pets of your home. These living and non-living things together make your home. Look at the following picture and list out the living and non-living things, in the pond.

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